Q. What are your thoughts on winning the Padma Vibhushan, and how important is it vis-a-vis the music you are creating?
I am delighted the Indian classical violin is being recognised for this prestigious honour. I'm told this is the first time the Padma Vibhushan is being given to an Indian violinist, so it's a double whammy. Music is everything to me. I connect with it spiritually and I want to help the audience also to find such a connection.

Q. What brought you to the Kerala Literature Festival?
I'm here to discuss my two books, *Raga Harmony*, which came out in 2024, and *Classical Music of India*. The former puts forth my 36-scale concept that will allow compositions by Indian composers based on Indian ragas to be performed by orchestras across the globe. This concept can create wonderful major orchestrations that have never been heard before.

Q. At a time when attention spans have shortened remarkably, what catalytic role can lit fests play?
They can play a very important role in nurturing the love of reading. I for one am delighted to see the huge crowds gathered at the Kerala Literature Festival with people of all age groups and backgrounds. Such fests also allow people to meet their favourite authors and interact with them.

Q. You created the Global Fusion concept and the Lakshminarayana Global Music Festival. What are your upcoming concerts?
I'm performing at the Jaipur Literature Festival on Feb. 1-2 followed by another concert at the Siddhivinayak temple in Mumbai. From May to July, I'll be performing across various cities in the US.

–with Neeta Lal

Q+A

The Perfect Note

Celebrated violinist **L. SUBRAMANIAM** is set to receive the Padma Vibhushan, the country's second-highest civilian honour



ALAMY